

Technology De-implementation Decision and Transition Plan

Software Portfolio Reduction

De-implementation Decision and Transition Plan: Software Portfolio Reduction

Initiative: Reduce redundant / low-value software subscriptions before the 2027-28 budget cycle.

Sponsor: Deputy Superintendent

Project lead: Chief Technology Officer

Current portfolio: 43 paid instructional / operational tools reviewed in this cycle

Planning target: Avoid or redirect at least \$180,000 in annual recurring cost without reducing required services.

Why De-implementation Is Needed

The district has accumulated overlapping tools through departmental purchases, grants, pilots, emergency implementations, and campus-level decisions. Some products have low utilization, duplicate existing capabilities, or create support and data-privacy overhead greater than their current value.

The goal is not simply to cut software. The goal is to create space for higher-value work and reduce unnecessary cost, risk, training burden, and fragmentation.

Four Options

Option	Definition	Use When
Remove	Stop the tool or practice completely	Low value; no required dependency; no replacement needed

Option	Definition	Use When
Reduce	Limit licenses, campuses, users, or features	Value exists for a smaller population
Re-engineer	Keep the outcome but simplify how it is delivered	Workflow has too many steps or overlapping products
Replace	Move to a more effective or sustainable alternative	Required capability remains but current solution is not best fit

Candidate Review

Tool / Service	Annual Cost	Active Use	Overlap	Decision	Rationale
Reading practice platform A	\$76,000	22% of licensed students	High	Reduce	Retain for identified intervention campuses only
Staff survey platform B	\$31,000	3 district surveys / yr	High	Replace	Existing district platform can meet need
Video creation tool C	\$48,000	9% staff monthly active	Medium	Reduce	Move from districtwide to role-based licensing
Legacy file-transfer service D	\$19,000	Low	Low	Remove	Secure approved alternative already deployed
Classroom assessment tool E	\$84,000	High	Medium	Keep	Strong instructional use and curriculum alignment

Decision Criteria

Each candidate is reviewed against:

1. Required instructional / operational outcome.
2. Utilization and user dependence.
3. Student and staff impact.
4. Accessibility and equity.

5. Privacy / security / data-retention implications.
6. Contract term, renewal date, auto-renewal, and exit obligations.
7. Integration and data-export dependencies.
8. Training and support burden.
9. Availability and quality of alternatives.
10. Total recurring cost and cost avoided.

Transition Plan

Phase	Action	Owner	Due	Evidence
Confirm	Validate usage and contract data	CTO + Purchasing	Jan 22	Portfolio review sheet
Decide	Approve keep / remove / reduce / replace decisions	Steering Team	Feb 12	Decision record
Notify	Inform owners, principals, and affected users	Comms + Department Leads	Feb 26	Communication log
Protect data	Export required records; confirm retention / deletion obligations	Data Governance + Vendor Owner	Mar 26	Data disposition checklist
Prepare alternatives	Configure replacement / reduced license groups	Technology + Curriculum	Apr-May	Readiness checklist
Train	Provide targeted transition support	Instructional Tech	May-Jun	Training resources
Cut over	End use of removed / replaced tools	Project Leads	Jun 30	Access disabled / new tool live
Close contracts	Complete non-renewal / termination steps	Purchasing	Contract deadline	Written confirmation
Review	Measure savings, service impact, and unintended effects	CTO	Sep 30	Post-transition review

Stakeholder Communication

Communication should explain:

- What is changing and when.
- The reason for the decision, using evidence rather than blame.
- What users will do instead.
- What happens to existing content / data.
- Where training and support will be available.
- Who can raise an unresolved dependency before cutover.

Success Measures

- At least \$180,000 in recurring annual cost avoided or redirected.
- 100% of required data exported, retained, transferred, or deleted according to district requirements.
- No critical workflow interruption at cutover.
- No removed subscription renews accidentally.
- Support tickets related to de-implementation fall below 2% of weekly volume within four weeks.
- Stakeholder review confirms required outcomes are still being met.

Post-Transition Questions

1. Did we save the expected time or money?
2. Did service quality stay the same or improve?
3. What unintended consequences appeared?
4. Did the replacement create a new burden elsewhere?
5. Should the district scale this de-implementation approach to another category?